TOMODACHI TV

CHERRY BLOSSOM

★ TOP 5 ★

Chase the bloom from Tokyo's lantern-lit moats up to a castle in the snowy north — five hanami crowns.



NO. 1

Chidorigafuchi 千鳥ヶ淵

Palace moat / boating hanami • Chiyoda, Tokyo (Kudanshita Stn) • Free Evening light-up

Cherry trees arch over the old Imperial Palace moat; rent a rowboat under the blossoms, return for the night illumination. Late Mar–early Apr.

02



Meguro River 目黒川

Riverside night sakura • Nakameguro, Tokyo (Naka-meguro Stn) • Free Iconic yozakura light-up

~800 cherry trees line the canal, branches meeting over the water; lanterns light the blossoms after dark. Late Mar–early Apr.

03



Maruyama Park 円山公園

City park / weeping cherry • Higashiyama, Kyoto (Gion-Shijo Stn) • Free Kyoto's most famous hanami park

Home to the ~12m Gion Shidarezakura weeping cherry, illuminated nightly, beside Yasaka Shrine. Late Mar–early Apr.

04



Mount Yoshino 吉野山

Sacred mountainside mass bloom • Yoshino, Nara (Yoshino Stn + ropeway) • Free UNESCO; Japan's top cherry mountain

~30,000 cherry trees bloom in tiers up the slopes, staggering the season into a month-long relay. Early–late Apr by elevation.

05



Hirosaki Castle Park 弘前城公園

Castle park / northern bloom • Hirosaki, Aomori (Chuo-Hirosaki Stn) • Free (festival inner zone paid) Top 100 cherry sites

~2,600 cherry trees frame the castle and moats, famed for floating 'petal-carpet' blossoms and night light-up. Late Apr–early May.

PHOTO CREDITS

No. 1 Kirin7739 · CC BY 4.0 · commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Cherry_blossoms_and_boat_at_Chidorigafuchi.jpg
No. 2 Manish Prabhune · CC BY 2.0 · commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Meguro_River_Cherry_Blossom_Illumination.png
No. 3 MShades · CC BY-ND 2.0 · www.flickr.com/photos/mshades/456512823/
No. 4 Luka Peternel · CC BY-SA 4.0 · commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Yoshino-yama-hills-cherry-blossom-2018-Luka-Peternel.jpg
No. 5 掬茶 · CC BY-SA 4.0 · commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Cherry_blossoms_along_the_moat_of_Hirosaki_Castle_at_night_20260420a.jpg

Photos are licensed images from free photo libraries. They may not show the exact place listed. Cropped and color-adjusted for layout. ND photos unaltered.